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HTML media elements 30m

Multimedia content includes images, videos, audio, animations and recordings. Multimedia content is supported by HTML and can be inserted into HTML documents if you use the correct elements.

The HTML multimedia elements are summarised below.

<code></code>	Defines a simple image file
<code><video></code>	Defines an embedded video file
<code><audio></code>	Defines an embedded audio file

Images

The `<img>` element is used to embed an image. However, to embed an image you also need to use the `<src>` and `<alt>` attributes. The `<src>` attribute is used to specify the path to the image, while the `<alt>` attribute is used to specify an alternative description of the image.



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HTML

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```

```



Resources

1x 0.5x 0.25x

Rerun

Example 5.19 Image



The `<alt>` text is displayed when the image fails to load or if the user is using a screen reader for accessibility reasons. This should be considered a requirement for all images you use within your pages.

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It is recommended that you also specify the width and height of your image to ensure image quality.

Videos

The `<video>` element is used to embed a video. Similar to inserting an image, you also need to use the `<src>` attribute inside a `<source>` element to specify a path to the video. The width and height attributes allow you to modify the width and height of the video.

There are additional attributes you can add, such as controls which will display the video controls (play and pause buttons) or autoplay, which will make the video play automatically.



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HTML

Result

EDIT ON

```
<video width="300" height="200"
controls>
  <source
src="https://www.w3schools.com/html/mov_bk
type="video/mp4">
  Your browser does not support this
video.
</video>
```

Resources1x0.5x0.25xRerun

Example 5.20 Video



The text 'Your browser does not support this video' will be displayed only if the video fails to load. It is recommended to add this text.

Skip to main content **<audio>** works similarly to **<video>**; however, there are no width or height

attributes for an audio file.

You can also embed external resources (images, videos and animations) using the `<embed>` and `<object>` elements. However, these elements are not commonly used because the `<img>`, `<video>` and `<audio>` tags are better to use to embed these types of multimedia content, and the `<object>` element was initially created to embed plugins, which aren't supported by most browsers anymore.

Dig deeper

To learn more about multimedia elements and their attributes, explore these resources:

- This article on *Multimedia and Embedding*, to learn more about how you can make your web content more interesting by embedding multimedia content.

W3Schools has tutorials on how to embed different types of multimedia content. Their tutorials give examples of embedding and using attributes, and they have the option to try it yourself:

- HTML video
- HTML audio
- HTML YouTube videos
- HTML images.



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Thoughts on this page?

